5 Things Every Expat Should Know Before Getting a Car in Singapore

A short welcome read from ExpatAutoAdviser

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ExpatAutoAdviser.com 5 Things Every Expat Should Know Before Getting a Car in Singapore Your quick starter guide from ExpatAutoAdviser A quick starter guide from the ExpatAutoAdviser team — the five things worth knowing before you start looking at cars. Keep an eye on your inbox for more detailed guides and market updates. 1 The COE will shock you A Certificate of Entitlement — essentially the right to own a car for 10 years — costs S$80,000-140,000 on top of the car itself. This is the single biggest cost component and it fluctuates every two weeks at auction. 2 Cars have a 10-year expiry date Every car in Singapore runs on a 10-year COE clock. At year 10 you scrap it (and get a partial rebate), renew the COE, or sell. This means depreciation works completely differently to the UK. 3 Consider renting before buying If your posting is 2-3 years, a car lease often makes more financial sense than buying. You avoid the COE gamble and the resale risk. Run the numbers before you commit. 4 Convert your UK licence early UK licences convert directly under Singapore's Direct Issue List — no driving test required. Do it in your first month while everything else is chaotic. You'll need an appointment, a fee, and an eye test. 5 Get a real insurance quote first Expat driver + minimal Singapore no-claims discount + expensive car = premium shock. Get a real written quote from at least two insurers before you sign anything at the showroom. Want the full breakdown? Visit ExpatAutoAdviser.com for detailed guides on COE, FRT, insurance, and more. Published by NewMediaWorld Pte. Ltd., April 2026. ExpatAutoAdviser.com